



Crocodile Stitch Messy Bun/Ponytail Hat (Adult and child sizes)

Designed by Lianka Azulay© 2017



Model: Summer Walker



Model: Luanna Azulay

Technical Editor: Janet Smith

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Crocodile Stitch Messy Bun/Ponytail Hat (Adult and child sizes)

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or



Materials:

Hat showcased in pattern were made with 1 skein of Bonita Yarns Dream Baby, DK weight (100% acrylic; 393 yards/m: 360) in Pink Fuchsia Degrade and Lilac (top picture).

Hats on bottom pictures were made with Merino Dream, Sport weight (50% wool, 50% acrylic; 328 yards/ 360 m) in Fuchsia Pink Shades and Bird of Paradise Degrade.

You can purchase these yarns on my online yarn shop: [Bonita Patterns & Yarns](http://BonitaPatterns.com)

Yardage: Approximately 330 yards

Sizes F (3.75 mm) or H (5.00 mm) crochet hook – see gauge for further instructions

Yarn needle

Gauge:

With F crochet hook for #3 (light) yarn or H crochet hook for #2 (fine) yarn:

Row 1: Ch 9, sc in 2nd ch from hook and across, turn. (8 sc)

Row 2 – 8: Ch 1, working in back loops only, sc across, turn. (8 sc)

8 sc and 8 rows = 2"

CHECK YOUR GAUGE. Use any size hook to obtain gauge, you may need to size up or down by as much as 2 hook sizes.

Finished Size:

Adult - Fits a 22 - 23" head circumference

Child – Fits a 18 – 20" head circumference

Abbreviations:

Beginning (beg)
Chain (ch)
Double Crochet (dc)
Double Crochet Two Stitches Together (dc2tog)
Front Post Double Crochet (FPdc)
Repeat (rep)
Single Crochet (sc)
Single Crochet Two Stitches Together (sc2tog)
Slip Stitch (sl st)
Space (sp)
Stitch (st)
V-Stitch (V-st)
Yarn Over (yo)

Special Stitches Used:

Double Crochet Two Stitches Together (dc2tog):

Yarn over, insert hook in stitch indicated, and pull up a loop, 3 loops on hook. Yo, pull through 2 loops. Yo, insert in next st, pull up a loop, 4 loops on hook. Yo, pull through 2 loops, 3 loops on hook. Yo, pull through all 3 loops.

Front Post Double Crochet (fpdc): Yo and insert hook from the front to the back around the post of the dc of previous row. Complete as for a regular dc stitch.

Single Crochet Two Stitches Together (sc2tog): insert hook in stitch indicated, and pull up a loop, 2 loops on hook, Yo, pull through both loops.

V-Stitch (V-st): Work (1 dc, ch 1, 1 dc) in stitch indicated.

Pattern Notes:

1. Ribbed band is work in rows and hat is worked in rounds from bottom to top.
2. Ribbed band of hat is worked first as a strip, then joined to form a ring. The first round of hat, where the scale section begins, is crocheted in row-ends of ribbed band.
3. In short, the “crocodile stitch” is formed by a two-row repeat: a row of V-sts followed by a row of scales (or shells). This is a fairly easy pattern to execute and fast to memorize. The only novelty about this design is **that the scales are crocheted in front of the V-sts with clusters of front post double crochets (fpdcs) from top to bottom, then from bottom to top**, as opposed to working them on top of the row, like in most shell patterns.

Adult Sizes

Directions for Ribbed Band - Adult

Ch 9

Row 1: Sc in second ch from hook and in each ch across – (8 sc)

Row 2 – Row 72: Ch 1 (doesn't count as sc), working in back loops only, sc in each sc across; turn. – (8 sc)

Joining: Bring the ends of the band together and join by sl st through the back loops of the last row and the corresponding sts of the beg ch. .

Directions for Hat - Adult

Rnd 1: With right side of ribbed band facing you and working in row-ends around its edge, ch 1, work 72 sc around edge of band (this equals 1 sc worked in each row-end); join with sl st in top of first sc – (72 sc)

Rnd 2: Ch 4 (count as a dc and a ch-1 sp), dc in same stitch as beg ch,* skip 2 sc, V-st in next sc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (24 V-sts)

Rnd 3: Ch 3 (count as a dc), working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 4 fpdc (see pic A), ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right; see pic B), working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc (see pic C), * skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (12 scales)

Rnd 4: Sl st in first 2 sts, sl st in ch-1 sp, ch 4 (count as a dc and a ch-1), dc in same ch-1 sp, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st (see pic D), * V-st in next ch-1 sp, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (24 V-sts)

Rnd 5: Sl st in first ch-1 sp, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc * skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (12 scales)

Rnd 6 – Rnd 17: Rep Rnd 4 and Rnd 5, alternately, ending on rnd 5 (a round of scales).

Rnd 18 (decrease): Ch 3 (count as dc), dc in next ch-1 sp (beg ch 3 and first dc counts a one dc2tog), (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 3 times, * dc2tog over next 2 ch-1 sp of V-sts, (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 3 times, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (18 V-sts + 3 dc2tog)

Rnd 19: Ch 1, *working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, (skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, (V point of V-st will be pointing right) work 5 fpdc) **twice, skip next V-st, and next dc2tog**, rep from * around, to last 6 V-sts, (working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc) 3 times; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (9 scales)

Rnd 20 (decrease): Ch 3 (count as dc), dc in next ch-1 sp (beg ch 3 and first dc counts a one dc2tog), (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 2 times, * dc2tog over next 2 ch-1 sp of V-sts, (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 2 times, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (12 V-sts + 3 dc2tog)

Rnd 21: Ch 1, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, * **skip next V-st, and next dc2tog**, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, skip next V-st, working from **top to bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, repeat from * around to last V-st, skip next V-st; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (6 scales)

Rnd 22: Ch 1, sc in next 2 sts, sc in next ch-1 sp, sc in next 2 sts, * sc in next ch-1 sp, sc in next 2 sts, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first sc – (36 scs)

Rnd 23 (decrease): Ch 1, * sc in next 4 sc, sc2tog over next 2 sc, rep from * around; **Note: Your last sc2tog will be over the last sc and the st right before your beg ch to prevent a hole being created by the join,** join with sl st in top of first sc – (30 sts)

Rnd 24 (decrease): Ch 1, * sc in next 3 sc, sc2tog over next 2 sc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first sc. **Fasten off, weave in all ends.** – (24 scs)

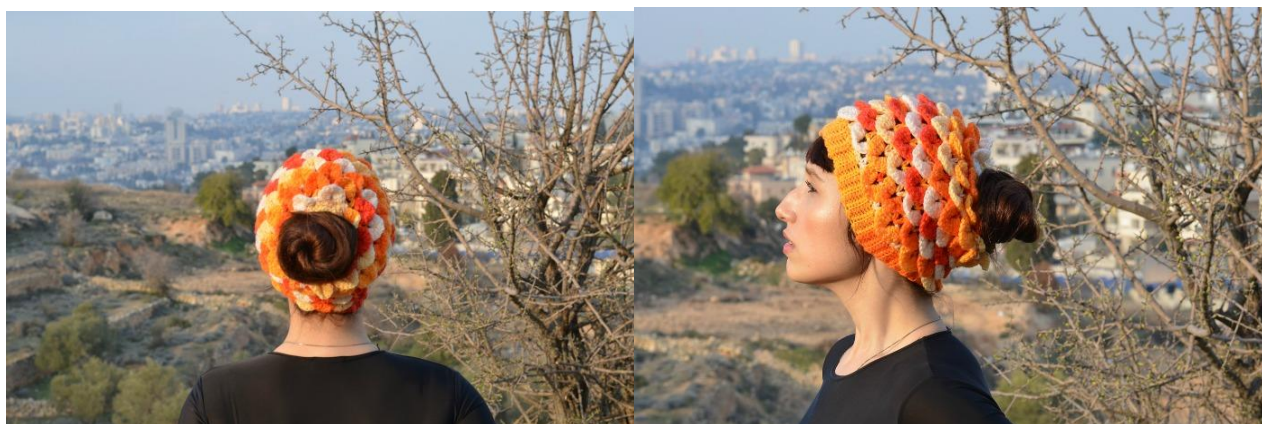
Instructions to Close Up Top as a Traditional Hat - Adult

In order to close up the top, after Rnd 21 crochet Rnds as follows:

Rnd 22 (decrease): Ch 3 (count as dc), dc in next ch-1 sp (beg ch 3 and first dc counts a one dec), yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp, * dc2tog over next dc and next ch-1 sp of V-sts, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (6 V-sts + 3 dc2tog)

Rnd 23: Ch 1, working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, (skip next V-st, and next dc2tog, working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc) twice; join with sl st in top of first dc. **Fasten off** leaving a long tail of yarn to close up top – (3 scales)

Closing hat top: With yarn needle, thread tail through spaces of V-sts of last round twice, pull to gather top tightly, and knot securely.



Hat showcased in Bonita Yarns Dream Baby in Citrus Degrade colorway.

Child Sizes

Directions for Ribbed Band - Child

Ch 9

Row 1: Sc in second ch from hook and in each ch across – (8 sc)

Row 2 – Row 66: Ch 1 (doesn't count as sc), working in back loops only, sc in each sc across; turn. – (8 sc)

Joining: Bring the ends of the band together and join by sl st through the back loops of the last row and the corresponding sts of the beg ch.

Directions for Hat - Child

Rnd 1: With right side of ribbed band facing you and working in row-ends around its edge, ch 1, work 72 sc around edge of band (this equals 1 sc worked in each row-end); join with sl st in top of first sc – (66 sc)

Rnd 2: Ch 4 (count as a dc and a ch-1 sp), dc in same stitch as beg ch,* skip 2 sc, V-st in next sc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (22 V-sts)

Rnd 3: Ch 3 (count as a dc), working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 4 fpdc (see pic A), ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right; see pic B), working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc (see pic C), * skip next V-st, working from **top** to **bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (11 scales)

Rnd 4: Sl st in first 2 sts, sl st in ch-1 sp, ch 4 (count as a dc and a ch-1), dc in same ch-1 sp, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st (see pic D), * V-st in next ch-1 sp, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (22 V-sts)

Rnd 5: Sl st in first ch-1 sp, working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc * skip next V-st, working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (11 scales)

Rnd 6 – Rnd 15: Rep Rnd 4 and Rnd 5, alternately, ending on rnd 5 (a round of scales).

Note: if the child has a small head, and you are using #3 yarn, you will want to skip Rnds 14 and 15 (omitting a V-st and scale rnd) and continue to Rnd 16.

Rnd 16 (decrease): Ch 3 (count as dc), dc in next ch-1 sp (beg ch 3 and first dc counts as one dc2tog), (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 3 times, * dc2tog over next 2 ch-1 sp of V-sts, (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 3 times, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (16 V-sts + 3 dc2tog)

Rnd 17: Ch 1, *working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of next V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, (skip next V-st, working from **top** to **bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, (V point of V-st will be pointing right) work 5 fpdc) **twice, skip next V-st, and next dc2tog**, rep from * around, to last 6 V-sts, (working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, skip next V-st, working from **top** to **bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc) 3 times; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (8 scales)

Rnd 18 (decrease): Ch 3 (count as dc), dc in next ch-1 sp (beg ch 3 and first dc counts as one dc2tog), (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 2 times, * dc2tog over next 2 ch-1 sp of V-sts, (yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp) 2 times, (V-st in next ch-1 sp) 2 times; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (10 V-sts + 3 dc2tog)

Rnd 19: Ch 1, working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom* (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, skip next V-st, working from **top** to **bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, * **skip next V-st, and next dc2tog**, working from **top** to **bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, skip next V-st, working from **top** to **bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, repeat from * around to last 4 V-sts, **skip next V-st and next dc2tog**, working from **top** to **bottom** work 5 fpdc around post of first dc of next V-st, ch 1, *turn work so V-st is sideways*, working from **bottom** to **top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, skip last V-st; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (5 scales)

Rnd 20: Ch 1, sc in next 2 sts, sc in next ch-1 sp, sc in next 2 sts, * sc in next ch-1 sp, sc in next 2 sts, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first sc – (30 scs)

Rnd 21 (decrease): Ch 1, * sc in next 4 sc, sc2tog over next 2 sc, rep from * around; **Note: Your last sc2tog will be over the last sc and the st right before your beg ch to prevent a hole being created by the join**, join with sl st in top of first sc – (25 sts)

Rnd 22 (decrease): Ch 1, * sc in next 3 sc, sc2tog over next 2 sc, rep from * around; join with sl st in top of first sc. **Fasten off, weave in all ends.** – (20 scs)

Instructions to Close Up Top as a Traditional Hat - Child

In order to close up the top, after Rnd 19 crochet Rnds as follows:

Rnd 20 (decrease): Ch 3 (count as dc), dc in next ch-1 sp (beg ch 3 and first dc counts a one dec), yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp, * dc2tog over next dc and next ch-1 sp of V-sts, yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st, V-st in next ch-1 sp, repeat from * around; join with sl st in top of first dc. – (6 V-sts + 2 dc2tog)

Rnd 21: Ch 1, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom (V point of V-st will be facing right), working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc, (skip next V-st, and next dc2tog, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 5 fpdc, ch 1, turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom, working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc) twice; join with sl st in top of first dc. **Fasten off** leaving a long tail of yarn to close up top – (3 scales)

Closing hat top: With yarn needle, thread tail through spaces of V-sts of last round twice, pull to gather top tightly, and knot securely.

Photo Tutorial:

Note: Yarn weight and hook size were changed for better visualization of stitches on photos.



(Picture A) Ch 3, working from **top to bottom** around post of first dc of first V-st, work 4 fpdc.



(Picture B) Turn work so V-st is sideways and post of second dc of V-st is on the bottom (V point of V-st will be facing right).



(Picture C) Working from **bottom to top** around post of second dc of V-st, work 5 fpdc.



(Picture C cont.) First crocodile scale completed.



(Picture D) Yo, insert hook in next sp between scales and in ch-1 sp directly behind scales and complete a V-st.



(Picture D cont.) V-st completed.

Should you have any questions about this pattern, please contact me at patternsupport@bonitapatterns.com and I will be happy to assist you.

You can purchase unique yarns featured on my patterns at my online yarn shop:

www.bonitapatterns.com

Worldwide shipping.

